

I'll keep **gap** at the same expanded reference standard—family forms, constructions, established compounds, specialist branches, and distinctions rather than only the ordinary dictionary senses.

Word family: **gap / gaps / gapped / gapping / gapless**

Base word: gap

Plural: gaps

Verb forms: gaps, gapped, gapping

Related forms: gapless

Useful compounds/extensions: gap year, generation gap, age gap, pay gap, gender gap, skills gap, knowledge gap, achievement gap, funding gap, market gap, output gap, price gap, band gap, spark gap, air gap, gap junction, anion gap, information gap, lexical gap, gap analysis, gap-fill exercise, gapless playback, gapped alignment

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “The fact that proper study space is insufficient does not mean restaurants should be expected to **fill the gap** for free.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **gap** means **a missing service, resource, or provision that is needed but is not currently available in sufficient quantity**.

Hong Kong students need suitable places to study, but the supply of:

- * quiet homes,
- * library seats,
- * study rooms,
- * classrooms,

is insufficient.

That shortage creates a **gap**.

繁體中文： **缺口；不足之處；需求存在但供應 / 服務未能滿足的部分**

中文翻譯：

> “...restaurants should be expected to **fill the gap** for free.”

「.....並不代表應該要求餐廳免費**填補這個資源 / 服務缺口**。」

Here:

****fill the gap = 提供目前缺少但實際需要的服務、資源或功能****

A. PHYSICAL OPENING / BREAK

1. ****gap = opening between two things (空隙) — 空隙 ; 間隙****

This is the central literal meaning.

Practice 1

> “There is a small ****gap**** between the door and the floor.”

「門和地板之間有一道小****空隙****。」

Practice 2

> “Light came through a ****gap**** in the curtains.”

「光線從窗簾的一道****縫隙****透進來。」

****gap = 兩件原本分開或接近的東西之間沒有被填滿的空間****

2. ****gap between objects = physical distance separating them (間距) — 距離 ; 間隔****

Practice 3

> “Leave a small ****gap**** between the chairs.”

「椅子之間留一點****間距****。」

Practice 4

> “The ****gap**** between the two buildings is very narrow.”

「兩棟建築物之間的****間隔****很窄。」

This differs slightly from a “hole”: the emphasis is the ****distance separating two objects****.

3. **gap in a fence/wall/hedge = break/opening allowing passage (缺口) — 缺口 ; 破口**

Practice 5

> “The dog escaped through a **gap** in the fence.”

「狗從圍欄的**缺口**逃了出去。」

4. **gap in the clouds = opening between clouds (雲隙)**

> “Sunlight appeared through a gap in the clouds.”

「陽光從雲層的**空隙**照下來。」

5. **gap in a line/queue/crowd = empty space within a sequence (隊伍中的空位)**

Practice 6

> “She stepped into a **gap** in the crowd.”

「她走進人群中的一個**空位 / 空隙**。」

6. **gap in traffic = opening between vehicles (車流空檔)**

Practice 7

> “Wait for a **gap** in the traffic before crossing.”

「等車流出現**空檔**後才過馬路。」

Here **gap** means a temporary physical opportunity created by sufficient distance between vehicles.

7. **gap in a defence/defense = opening opponents can exploit (防線缺口)**

Practice 8

> “The striker found a **gap** in the defence.”

「前鋒找到防線中的一個**空檔 / 缺口**。」

Used in many sports.

B. GEOGRAPHY

8. **gap = low opening/pass through hills or mountains (山口) — 山口 ; 山脈缺口**

Especially common in geographical names and American English.

Practice 9

> “The road passes through a narrow **gap** in the mountains.”

「道路穿過山脈中的狹窄**山口**。」

Examples of place names can contain:

> X Gap

The underlying concept remains a physical opening through a ridge.

C. TEETH

9. **gap between teeth = space separating teeth (牙縫) — 牙齒間隙 ; 牙縫**

Practice 10

> “She has a small **gap** between her front teeth.”

「她兩顆門牙之間有一道小**牙縫**。」

10. **gap-toothed = having noticeable spaces between teeth (有牙縫的)**

> “a gap-toothed smile”

= **露出明顯牙縫的笑容**

Related medical/dental term:

> ****diastema****

= 牙間隙

D. TIME INTERVAL

11. ****gap** = period of time between two events (時間間隔) — 間隔；空檔******

Practice 11

> “There was a two-hour ****gap**** between the meetings.”

「兩場會議之間有兩小時的****空檔****。」

Practice 12

> “After a long ****gap****, they met again.”

「相隔很長一段時間後，他們再次見面。」

12. ****gap in a schedule** = free period (行程空檔) ******

> “I have a gap in my schedule after lunch.”

「我午飯後的行程有一段****空檔****。」

13. ****gap between trains/buses/services** = interval between departures (班次間隔) ******

> “There is a thirty-minute gap between trains.”

「列車班次之間相隔三十分鐘。」

E. EMPLOYMENT / HISTORY GAP

14. ****employment gap** = period when someone was not employed (工作空窗期) ******

Practice 13

> “She explained the six-month **gap** in her employment history.”

「她解釋了履歷中六個月的**就業空窗期**。」

Common:

- * employment gap
- * career gap
- * gap in a CV/résumé

15. **career gap / career break**

A **career gap** emphasizes the period absent from continuous employment.

Not necessarily negative; it may result from:

- * study
- * caregiving
- * travel
- * illness
- * career transition

F. GAP YEAR

16. **gap year** = year/period taken between stages of education or work (間隔年) — 空檔年 ; 間隔年

Practice 14

> “She took a **gap year** before university.”

「她入大學前休了一個**間隔年**。」

People may use it for:

- * travel
- * work
- * volunteering
- * personal development

Despite the name, it does not always have to be exactly twelve months in loose everyday use.

17. **take a gap year**

The normal verb construction:

> take a gap year

= **休讀 / 安排一個間隔年**

G. DIFFERENCE BETWEEN TWO LEVELS / GROUPS

18. **gap = significant difference between two things (差距) — 差距**

A major figurative branch.

Practice 15

> “There is a large **gap** between rich and poor households.”

「富裕和貧困家庭之間有很大的**差距**。」

Practice 16

> “The **gap** between expectations and reality was enormous.”

「期望與現實之間的**落差**非常大。」

gap = 兩方在數值、狀況、能力、觀點等方面的差異

19. **widening gap = difference becoming larger (差距擴大) **

> “The gap is widening.”

「差距正在**擴大**。」

20. **narrowing gap = difference becoming smaller (差距縮小) **

> “The two teams have narrowed the gap.”

「兩隊之間的差距已經**縮小**。」

H. PAY / INCOME / WEALTH

21. **pay gap = difference in pay between groups (薪酬差距) **

Practice 17

> “The report examined the pay **gap** between different groups.”

「報告研究不同群體之間的**薪酬差距**。」

22. **gender pay gap = gender-based difference in average/median pay measures (性別薪酬差距) **

A commonly used labour/economic term.

Important:

The exact calculation may compare:

- * hourly earnings,
- * annual earnings,
- * mean,
- * median,
- * adjusted or unadjusted measures.

So **gender pay gap** is not automatically identical to:

> unequal pay for the same job.

Those can be separate statistical/legal concepts.

23. **wage gap = 工資差距**

Often similar to **pay gap**, but exact measure depends on context.

24. **income gap = 收入差距**

Difference in income between:

- * individuals
- * groups
- * regions
- * countries

25. **wealth gap = 財富差距**

Difference in accumulated assets/net wealth rather than current income.

Important distinction:

> income gap ≠ wealth gap.

I. AGE / GENERATION

26. **age gap = age difference (年齡差距) **

Practice 18

> “There is a ten-year age **gap** between them.”

「他們的年齡相差十年。」

27. **generation gap = differences in attitudes between generations (代溝) **

Practice 19

> “Technology can sometimes widen the generation **gap**.”

「科技有時會擴大**代溝**。」

generation gap = 不同世代在價值觀、態度、生活方式、語言等方面的差異

It is not simply a numerical age difference.

J. PERFORMANCE / ACHIEVEMENT DIFFERENCE

28. **achievement gap = difference in measured educational outcomes (學習成就差距) **

Used in education for differences in outcomes such as:

- * test performance
- * attainment
- * graduation
- * proficiency

Exact measures vary by study/system.

29. **attainment gap = 教育成就差距**

Especially common in British education terminology.

Related to but not always identical with **achievement gap**.

30. **performance gap = difference between actual and desired performance (表現差距) **

Used in:

- * education
- * business
- * sport
- * HR
- * operations

K. KNOWLEDGE / SKILLS

31. **knowledge gap = missing knowledge / disparity in knowledge (知識缺口) **

Can mean either:

1. something nobody/one person does not yet know;
2. a difference in knowledge between groups.

> “The research aims to fill an important knowledge **gap**.”

「這項研究旨在填補一個重要的**知識缺口**。」

32. **skills gap** = mismatch/shortage of required skills (技能缺口)

Practice 21

> “Employers reported a growing **skills gap**.”

「僱主表示**技能缺口**正在擴大。」

This can mean:

- * workers lack needed skills;
- * available workforce skills do not match employer requirements.

33. **learning gap** = missing knowledge/skills in a learner's development (學習缺口)

> “The teacher identified several learning gaps.”

「老師發現學生存在幾個**學習缺口**。」

34. **information gap** = missing information (資訊缺口)

> “There is still an information gap.”

「仍然存在**資訊缺口**。」

Can describe:

- * incomplete knowledge;
- * asymmetric information;
- * communicative tasks in language teaching.

The language-teaching sense is treated separately below.

L. MISSING PART / DEFICIENCY

35. **gap = something necessary that is missing (缺口) — 缺失；不足之處**

This is the **exact passage branch**.

Practice 22 — Original

> “Restaurants should not be expected to **fill the gap** for free.”

「不應要求餐廳免費**填補這個缺口**。」

Practice 23

> “The service fills a major **gap** in community care.”

「這項服務填補了社區照顧方面的一個重大**缺口**。」

36. **gap in provision = service/resource not adequately provided (供應缺口) **

> “There is a gap in childcare provision.”

「托兒服務存在**供應缺口**。」

37. **service gap = missing/insufficient service (服務缺口) **

> “The programme was created to address a service gap.”

「這個計劃是為了處理一個**服務缺口**而設。」

38. **resource gap = shortage between resources needed and available (資源缺口) **

> “Schools are trying to close the resource gap.”

「學校正設法縮小**資源缺口**。」

39. **capacity gap = shortage of available capacity (容量缺口) **

Common in:

- * infrastructure
- * healthcare
- * education
- * manufacturing

40. **coverage gap = part not covered by a service/system (覆蓋缺口) **

Can apply to:

- * insurance
- * telecommunications
- * healthcare
- * public services

Exact meaning depends on domain.

M. GAP IN EVIDENCE / ARGUMENT

41. **gap in evidence = missing evidence required to support a conclusion (證據缺口) **

> “There is a serious gap in the evidence.”

「證據中存在重大**缺口**。」

42. **gap in reasoning / logic = missing step in an argument (推理缺口) **

Practice 24

> “The argument contains a logical **gap**.”

「這項論證存在一個邏輯**缺口 / 跳躍**。」

Meaning:

> the conclusion does not follow because an intermediate premise/reasoning step is missing.

43. **gap in an explanation = missing explanatory step (解釋缺口) **

> “The theory leaves an important explanatory gap.”

「這個理論留下了一個重要的**解釋缺口**。」

N. GAP IN MEMORY / RECORDS

44. **gap in memory = period/event someone cannot remember (記憶空白) **

Practice 25

> “There is a gap in my memory of that evening.”

「我對當晚有一段**記憶空白**。」

45. **memory gap = 記憶缺失 / 空白**

Could be temporary/ordinary or clinically relevant depending on context.

The phrase alone does not establish a medical diagnosis.

46. **gap in the historical record = missing documentation (歷史紀錄缺口) **

> “The discovery fills a gap in the historical record.”

「這項發現填補了歷史紀錄中的**空白**。」

O. MARKET OPPORTUNITY

47. **gap in the market = unmet customer need (市場空缺) — 市場缺口 ; 市場空白**

Practice 26

> “They identified a **gap in the market** for affordable study spaces.”

「他們發現市場上存在平價學習空間的**市場缺口**。」

Meaning:

> consumers need/want something that existing suppliers do not adequately provide.

48. **market gap = unmet demand / unserved segment (市場空缺) **

Often used similarly to:

> gap in the market.

49. **fill a market gap = introduce product/service satisfying unmet demand (填補市場空缺) **

> “The product fills a gap in the market.”

「這項產品填補了市場上的**空白**。」

50. **gap ≠ niche**

Important:

gap in the market

= unmet need/opportunity.

niche

= specialized segment/position that may already be served.

A gap can create an opportunity to establish a niche.

P. FUNDING / FINANCE

51. **funding gap = difference between money needed and money available (資金缺口) **

Practice 27

> “The project faces a large funding **gap**.”

「這個項目面對巨大的**資金缺口**。」

This is one of the most important financial applications.

52. **financing gap = financing needed but not yet secured (融資缺口) **

Similar to funding gap, though domain distinctions can exist.

53. **budget gap = shortfall between planned expenditure and available revenue (預算缺口) **

> “The organization must close a budget gap.”

「機構必須填補**預算缺口**。」

54. **revenue gap = missing expected revenue (收入缺口) **

Difference between:

* required/expected revenue;

* actual/projected revenue.

Q. MACROECONOMICS

55. **output gap = difference between actual and potential economic output (產出缺口) **

A technical macroeconomic term.

Broadly:

> actual economic output – potential output,

though sign conventions/presentation differ.

Positive output gap

actual output above estimated potential.

Negative output gap

actual output below potential.

****繁體中文：產出缺口****

56. ****inflation gap / unemployment gap****

Specialist macroeconomic modelling terms exist, but definitions depend on the model.

They should not be interpreted generically without context.

R. BUSINESS: GAP ANALYSIS

57. ****gap analysis = comparison of current state with desired state (差距分析) ****

Practice 28

> “The company conducted a ****gap analysis****.”

「公司進行了****差距分析****。」

Normally asks:

- > Where are we now?
- > Where do we want to be?
- > What is missing between those states?

Used in:

- * business strategy
- * compliance
- * skills development
- * IT
- * quality management

58. ****performance gap in gap analysis****

Difference between:

- > current performance

and:

> target/desired performance.

59. **compliance gap** = difference between current and required compliance state (合規差距)

Common business/regulatory application.

S. FINANCIAL MARKETS — PRICE GAP

60. **price gap** = discontinuity between trading price ranges (價格跳空) ******

In financial charting, a **gap** occurs when an asset trades at a range that leaves a space relative to the previous period's range/close, depending on the definition/chart convention.

Practice 29

> “The stock opened with a large upward **gap**.”

「股票開市時出現大幅向上的**跳空**。」

61. **gap up** = open/move sharply higher with a price gap (跳空高開) ******

Practice 30

> “The stock **gapped up** after the announcement.”

「消息公布後，股票**跳空高開**。」

Here **gap** is a verb.

62. **gap down** = 跳空低開******

> “Shares **gapped down** the next morning.”

「股份翌日早上**跳空低開**。」

63. **fill/close a price gap = price later trades through previously skipped range (回補缺口) **

Financial charting expression:

> the gap was filled.

= 價格後來回到並交易過先前跳空區域。

Do not confuse with your passage's:

> fill a service gap.

64. **common / breakaway / continuation / exhaustion gap**

Technical chart-analysis classifications used by some traders.

They belong to specialist technical-analysis terminology rather than separate lexical senses of **gap**.

T. BANKING / RISK MANAGEMENT

65. **interest-rate gap / repricing gap = mismatch between rate-sensitive assets and liabilities (利率敏感缺口) **

A bank risk-management term.

Exact calculation depends on the framework/time bucket.

66. **duration gap = mismatch in duration of assets and liabilities (久期缺口) **

Used in interest-rate risk/asset-liability management.

Specialist finance.

67. **liquidity gap = mismatch between expected cash inflows/outflows (流動性缺口) **

Specialist banking/treasury use.

U. LINGUISTICS — LEXICAL GAP

68. **lexical gap** = concept/form lacking an ordinary lexical item (詞彙空缺)

A **lexical gap** occurs when a language lacks an expected/convenient word or form for a concept or position in a lexical pattern.

繁體中文： **詞彙空缺**

Example:

A concept may require a phrase because no single conventional word exists.

69. **semantic gap?**

Used in some linguistic/computational contexts for mismatch between:

- * intended meaning;
- * available representation.

But it is broader and field-dependent.

V. SYNTAX — GAP / FILLER-GAP

70. **gap** = syntactic position with no overt expression (句法空位)

In syntactic analysis, a **gap** can be an unpronounced position associated with another expression.

Example conceptually:

> “Which book did she say that he bought ____?”

The blank represents a syntactic **gap** associated with **which book**.

71. **filler-gap dependency = 填充語—空位依存關係**

A major syntax/psycholinguistics term.

* filler = overt displaced expression

* gap = corresponding missing position

72. **gapping = omission of repeated material in coordination (省略現象) **

Gapping is a specific linguistic phenomenon.

Example:

> “John ordered coffee, and Mary tea.”

The repeated verb **ordered** is omitted in the second clause.

**繁體中文 : ** often **空缺化 / 動詞省略 (依理論譯法) **

This is an independent technical use of the -ing family form.

W. LANGUAGE TEACHING

73. **gap-fill exercise = fill missing words in text (填空練習) **

Practice 31

> “Complete the **gap-fill exercise**.”

「完成這份**填空練習**。」

Students supply:

* missing words

* phrases

* grammatical forms

74. **gap-fill / fill-in-the-blank**

Very similar educational terms.

****Gap-fill**** is especially common in British language-teaching terminology.

75. ****information-gap activity = communication task where participants hold different information (資訊差活動)****

A classic language-teaching task.

Student A and Student B have different information and must communicate to complete the task.

****繁體中文： ** **資訊差活動 / 信息差活動****

The “gap” is deliberately created to generate genuine communication.

X. PHYSICS — ENERGY / BAND GAP

76. ****energy gap = energy difference between states (能隙)****

A general physics concept:

> difference in energy between allowed states/levels.

77. ****band gap = energy range between electronic bands (能帶隙 / 帶隙)****

A major solid-state/semiconductor term.

Broadly, the ****band gap**** is the energy difference between relevant electronic bands, commonly discussed between valence and conduction bands in semiconductor contexts.

****繁體中文： ** **能隙 / 能帶隙****

78. ****direct / indirect band gap****

Semiconductor/solid-state physics distinguishes:

* direct band gap

* indirect band gap

based on the momentum-space relationship of relevant electronic states.

Highly specialist.

Y. ELECTRICAL / ELECTRONICS

79. **spark gap = small gap across which an electric spark can jump (火花間隙) **

Practice 32

> “The voltage became high enough to jump the spark **gap**.”

「電壓高到足以跨越**火花間隙**產生放電。」

80. **spark-plug gap = gap between spark-plug electrodes (火花塞電極間隙) **

A specific automotive application.

Correct gap affects ignition performance.

81. **air gap — electrical/magnetic = physical non-conducting space (氣隙) **

In electrical machinery/magnetics, an **air gap** may be the physical gap between components such as:

* rotor and stator;

* magnetic-core sections.

繁體中文： ** **氣隙

Z. AIR GAP — CYBERSECURITY

82. **air-gapped computer/network = physically/logically isolated from other networks (隔離網絡) **

Practice 33

> “The sensitive system is **air-gapped** from the public internet.”

「敏感系統與公共互聯網保持**實體 / 網絡隔離**。」

An **air gap** in cybersecurity means intentional isolation to reduce network connectivity/exposure.

air-gapped is a major derived adjective.

83. **air-gap security does not mean invulnerable**

An air-gapped system can still face threats through:

- * removable media
- * insiders
- * supply chain
- * physical access

So **air-gapped** ≠ perfectly secure.

AA. AIR GAP — PLUMBING

84. **plumbing air gap = physical separation preventing backflow contamination (空氣間隙)**

A physical separation between a water outlet and a possible contaminated water level.

Used as a backflow-prevention principle.

Same words as cybersecurity **air gap**, different domain.

AB. BIOLOGY — GAP JUNCTION

85. **gap junction = channel connecting adjacent cells (間隙連接)**

A major cell-biology term.

Gap junctions allow certain ions/small molecules to pass directly between adjacent cells through specialized intercellular channels.

繁體中文：間隙連接

86. ****gap-junction communication****

> intercellular communication through gap junctions.

Specialist biology.

AC. CELL CYCLE

87. ****G1 / G2 gap phases = cell-cycle gap phases (間期階段) ****

Historically called ****gap phases****:

* G1

* G2

They occur around the DNA-synthesis phase in the cell cycle.

The “gap” terminology is conventional biological nomenclature.

AD. DEVELOPMENTAL BIOLOGY

88. ****gap gene = developmental gene class (缺口基因 / 間隙基因) ****

In developmental genetics, especially classic *Drosophila* segmentation studies, ****gap genes**** specify broad regions of the embryo; mutations can produce missing contiguous body segments.

Highly specialist.

AE. MEDICINE — ANION GAP

89. ****anion gap = calculated difference in measured serum ions (陰離子間隙) ****

A clinical laboratory calculation commonly used in evaluation of acid-base disorders.

A common formulation uses measured:

* sodium

* chloride

* bicarbonate

with laboratory-specific conventions.

****繁體中文： ** **陰離子間隙****

Reference ranges/formulas vary, so the term should not be interpreted without the actual laboratory context.

90. ****high anion gap / normal anion gap****

Clinical acid-base classifications.

These are medical interpretations, not ordinary “gaps.”

AF. OSMOLAL / OSMOLAR GAP

91. ****osmolal gap = difference between measured and calculated osmolality (滲透壓間隙) ****

Used in clinical toxicology/metabolic assessment.

Exact formulas and reference thresholds vary.

Commonly called:

> osmolal gap

rather than simply ****osmolar gap****, though both may appear.

AG. MEDICINE — CARE GAP / TREATMENT GAP

92. ****treatment gap = difference between people needing treatment and receiving it (治療缺口) ****

Used in public health.

> “The programme aims to close the treatment gap.”

「計劃旨在縮小****治療服務缺口****。」

93. **care gap** = missing/inadequate healthcare provision (照護缺口) ******

A broad health-services term.

AH. BIOINFORMATICS

94. **gap** = missing/inserted position in sequence alignment (序列空位) ******

In DNA/protein sequence alignment, a **gap** is introduced to represent an insertion/deletion relationship between sequences.

Often shown as:

> *

95. **gapped alignment** = alignment containing gaps (含空位比對) ******

A common bioinformatics term.

96. **gap penalty** = score/cost assigned to introducing/extending gaps (空位罰分) ******

Sequence-alignment algorithms commonly use penalties such as:

- * gap-opening penalty

- * gap-extension penalty

Highly established computational-biology terminology.

AI. GENOMICS

97. **sequence gap / assembly gap** = unresolved region in genome assembly (序列缺口) ******

A genome assembly may contain gaps where sequence is:

- * unknown

- * unresolved

- * unassembled

98. **gapless assembly / gapless genome**

Means:

> no unresolved sequence gaps under the specified representation.

Specialist genomics usage.

AJ. COMPUTING / AUDIO

99. **gapless playback** = playback without audible pauses between tracks (無縫播放)

Practice 34

> “The player supports **gapless playback**.”

「播放器支援**無縫播放**。」

Important for:

- * live albums
- * classical works
- * concept albums

where tracks are intended to flow continuously.

100. **gapless** = without intervening gaps (無間隙的 ; 無縫的)

General technical adjective:

- * gapless playback
- * gapless sequence
- * gapless coverage

Meaning depends on domain.

AK. WEB / CSS

101. **gap** = spacing between rows/columns/items in CSS (網頁排版) — 間距

In modern CSS, the `gap` property controls spacing between items in layouts such as:

- * grid
- * flexbox
- * multi-column layout

Conceptually:

> space between layout tracks/items.

This is a technical application of the physical-distance sense.

AL. COMPUTER SCIENCE — GAP BUFFER

102. **gap buffer** = text-editing data structure (間隙緩衝區)

A **gap buffer** stores text with an unused region—the **gap**—near the editing location to make nearby insertions/deletions efficient.

Specialist computer-science term.

AM. MANUFACTURING / CONSTRUCTION

103. **expansion gap** = space left to allow thermal/material movement (伸縮縫 / 膨脹間隙)

Practice 35

> “Leave an expansion **gap** around the flooring.”

「地板四周要留一道**伸縮縫**。」

Allows materials to:

- * expand
- * contract
- * move

without buckling/damage.

104. **clearance gap = required space between moving/adjacent parts (間隙) **

Engineering use.

Exact technical term varies by system.

AN. TRANSPORT: PLATFORM GAP

105. **platform gap = space between train and platform (月台空隙) **

Familiar through:

> **Mind the gap.**

Practice 36

> “Please mind the **gap** between the train and the platform.”

「請小心列車與月台之間的**空隙**。」

106. **Mind the gap = 小心月台空隙**

Originally a transport safety warning.

It can also be used figuratively in titles/slogans to mean:

> pay attention to a difference, deficiency, or divide.

AO. CONVERSATION / SILENCE

107. **gap in conversation = pause/silence (談話空檔) **

> “There was an awkward gap in the conversation.”

「談話中出現一段尷尬的**沉默 / 空檔**。」

This combines the **time interval** and **missing-content** senses.

AP. TEXT / SPACING

108. **gap between words/lines/sections = blank space (空白間距) **

> “Leave a gap between the paragraphs.”

「段落之間留一些**空白 / 間距**。」

AQ. VERB **GAP**

109. **gap = create or leave a gap (使產生間隙) **

Technical/general verb:

> “The boards were gapped slightly apart.”

「木板之間留了少量**間隙**。」

Less common in ordinary speech than:

> leave a gap.

110. **gap = become separated/open (產生裂隙 / 間隙) **

Some material/construction contexts use:

> joints gapped open

meaning:

> a space developed between them.

Specialist.

111. **gap up / gap down — finance**

Already covered:

> price opens sharply above/below prior trading range.

This is probably the most common modern bare-verb use outside specialist physical contexts.

AR. ****GAPPED****

112. ****gapped** = containing gaps (有間隙的) ******

Examples:

- * gapped teeth
- * gapped alignment
- * gapped text

Context determines translation.

113. ****gapped text** = text containing deliberate blanks (有空格的文本) ******

Used in language teaching/testing.

Closely related to:

> gap-fill exercise.

AS. ****GAPLESS****

114. ****gapless** = continuous, without gaps (無縫的 ; 無間隙的) ******

Examples:

- * gapless playback
- * gapless sequence
- * gapless coverage

It remains a technical/productive adjective rather than a very common everyday one.

AT. HIGH-VALUE VERB COLLOCATIONS

115. **fill a gap = supply something missing (填補缺口) **

This is your passage construction.

Practice 37

> “The community centre helps **fill the gap** in study-space provision.”

「社區中心有助**填補學習空間供應的缺口**。」

116. **bridge a gap = connect two separated groups/positions (彌合差距) **

Practice 38

> “The programme aims to **bridge the gap** between school and employment.”

「這項計劃旨在**彌合**學校與就業之間的**差距**。」

The metaphor is a bridge crossing a physical gap.

117. **close the gap = eliminate/reduce difference or deficiency (縮小 / 消除差距) **

> “More resources are needed to close the gap.”

「需要更多資源來**縮小 / 填補差距**。」

118. **narrow the gap = reduce a difference (縮小差距) **

> “The second team narrowed the gap to two points.”

「第二隊把**差距縮小到兩分**。」

119. **widen the gap = increase the difference (擴大差距) **

> “Rising costs widened the gap between the two groups.”

「成本上升**擴大了兩個群體之間的差距**。」

120. **leave a gap = cause something to remain missing/empty (留下缺口) **

> “Her departure left a major gap in the team.”

「她離開後在團隊中留下了一個重大**空缺**。」

This can be:

- * staffing;
- * skills;
- * emotional;
- * functional.

121. **plug a gap = temporarily fill a shortage (堵住 / 暫時填補缺口) **

Especially BrE:

> “Temporary staff were hired to plug the gap.”

「公司聘用臨時員工來**暫時填補人手缺口**。」

Often suggests a practical, possibly temporary fix.

122. **paper over a gap?**

More natural idiom is:

> paper over the cracks

rather than *paper over a gap*.

So do not manufacture this collocation.

AU. IMPORTANT DISTINCTIONS

gap vs hole

hole

usually an actual empty opening in or through something.

gap

usually the space **between** things or a break in continuity.

> hole in a wall

> gap between two walls

But overlap exists:

> gap in a fence.

gap vs space

space

is very broad and neutral.

gap

usually implies:

> separation, interruption, or something missing.

> space between chairs

> gap between rich and poor

Only **gap** naturally carries the figurative “difference” meaning.

gap vs opening

opening

often emphasizes access or an intentionally/temporarily open place.

gap

emphasizes the empty break between surrounding parts.

> opening in the wall

> gap in the fence

Close physically.

gap vs crack

crack

= narrow split/fracture in material.

gap

= space separating parts.

A crack can widen into a gap, but the concepts differ.

gap vs interval

interval

= measured/structured separation in time, space, music, mathematics.

gap

often suggests empty time or interruption.

> ten-minute interval

> gap in the schedule

gap vs break

break

can mean pause/interruption.

gap

focuses on the empty period between events.

> lunch break

> two-hour gap between meetings

gap vs pause

pause

= temporary stopping of an activity.

gap

= interval between activities.

A pause can create a gap.

gap vs difference

difference

is the broad neutral term.

gap

often suggests a difference that is:

- * substantial;
- * measurable;
- * socially/economically significant;
- * potentially something to close.

> difference in opinions

> income gap

gap vs disparity

disparity

is more formal and often implies substantial inequality.

gap

is broader and more common.

- > wealth disparity

- > wealth gap

Very close in social/economic contexts.

gap vs divide

divide

suggests a deeper separation between groups, often social/ideological.

gap

can be simply a measurable difference.

- > generation gap

- > political divide

A divide often sounds harder to bridge.

gap vs shortfall

shortfall

specifically means:

- > amount by which supply/result falls below required/expected level.

gap

is broader.

- > funding gap

- > funding shortfall

A **shortfall** is quantitatively below target; a **gap** can be any missing provision.

gap vs shortage

shortage

= not enough of something.

gap

= the unmet portion/need created by that shortage.

> shortage of teachers

> staffing gap

gap vs deficit

deficit

often has a formal quantitative meaning:

> expenditure exceeds income;

> performance falls below benchmark.

gap

is more general.

> budget deficit

> funding gap

Not automatically interchangeable.

gap vs vacancy

vacancy

= unoccupied job, room, position, etc.

gap

= missing capability/person/resource more generally.

A vacancy may create a staffing gap.

gap vs omission

omission

= something was left out.

gap

= resulting missing part.

> omission in the report

> gap in the evidence

gap vs loophole

gap in a law/system

may mean an issue not adequately covered.

loophole

specifically means a weakness/ambiguity allowing rules to be avoided or exploited.

Not every legal gap is a loophole.

gap vs niche

As noted:

> market gap = unmet need

> niche = specialized market position/segment.

gap vs generation gap

A **generation gap** is not simply:

> age gap.

Age gap

numerical difference in age.

Generation gap

difference in attitudes/values associated with generations.

gap vs discrepancy

discrepancy

= inconsistency between two things expected to agree.

gap

= broader difference.

> discrepancy between two records

> gap between income groups

AV. GRAMMAR

123. **gap between A and B**

Very common for physical and figurative distance:

> gap between buildings

> gap between rich and poor

> gap between theory and practice

124. **gap in something**

Usually identifies where the missing/open portion exists:

> gap in the fence

> gap in knowledge

> gap in the schedule

> gap in the evidence

125. ****gap of + amount****

> “There is a gap of five years between the two studies.”

「兩項研究相隔五年。」

126. ****gap between + times/values****

> “a 20-point gap between the teams”

= 兩隊相差 20 分。

127. ****fill/bridge/close/narrow/widen + the gap****

High-value collocations:

- * fill = supply what is missing
- * bridge = connect separated sides
- * close = eliminate/reduce
- * narrow = reduce
- * widen = increase

These verbs are ****not interchangeable in every type of gap****.

AW. COUNTABILITY

****Gap**** is normally countable:

- > a gap
- > two gaps
- > several gaps

Examples:

- * a gap in the fence
- * an income gap
- * several knowledge gaps

In compounds it functions attributively:

- * gap analysis
- * gap year
- * gap junction
- * gap penalty

AX. FAMILY MAP

Family form	Main modern meanings	
-----	-----	
gap — physical	empty opening/space between things	
gap — time	interval or empty period between events	
gap — disparity	difference in amount, status, performance, attitude, etc.	
gap — deficiency	required information/resource/service that is missing	
gap — opportunity	unmet need, especially a market gap	
gap — specialist	technical interval/opening in finance, physics, biology, computing, linguistics, etc.	
gap — verb	create/become separated; in finance, gap up/down	
gapped	containing deliberate or actual gaps	
gapping	linguistic omission phenomenon; also ordinary -ing form	
gapless	continuous/without gaps	

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning	
-----	-----	
gap — physical opening	兩物 / 兩部分之間未被填滿的空隙、缺口	
gap — physical distance	兩個物體之間的間距	
gap in fence/wall	圍欄 / 牆中的缺口	
gap in traffic	車流中足以通過的空檔	
gap in defence	防線中的可利用空檔 / 缺口	
mountain gap	山脈中的低處 / 山口	
gap between teeth	牙齒間隙 / 牙縫	
gap — time	兩項事件之間的時間間隔 / 空檔	
employment gap	一段沒有工作的就業空窗期	
gap year	升學 / 就業階段之間安排的間隔年	
gap — disparity	兩組數值、水平、狀況等之間的差距	
pay/wage gap	薪酬 / 工資差距	
income gap	收入差距	
wealth gap	財富差距	
age gap	年齡差	
generation gap	不同世代在價值觀、態度等方面的代溝	
achievement/attainment gap	教育成果 / 成就上的群體差距	

knowledge gap	欠缺的知識，或群體間的知識差距	
skills gap	所需技能與現有技能之間的缺口	
learning gap	學習過程中欠缺的知識 / 能力	
gap — missing service/resource	有實際需要但現有供應 / 服務沒有滿足的缺口	
service/resource/capacity gap	服務、資源或容量不足形成的缺口	
gap in evidence	證據中欠缺的部分	
gap in reasoning	論證中欠缺的推理步驟	
gap in memory	無法回想的一段記憶空白	
gap in the market	現有產品 / 服務尚未滿足的市場需要	
funding/financing gap	所需資金與現有資金之間的缺口	
budget/revenue gap	預算 / 收入不足的差額	
output gap	實際經濟產出與潛在產出之間的差額	
gap analysis	比較目前狀態與目標狀態的差距分析	
price gap — finance	金融價格圖表上的跳空區域	
gap up/down	股票等跳空高開 / 低開	
repricing/duration/liquidity gap	銀行資產負債風險管理中的專門差額	
lexical gap	語言中缺少預期 / 方便的詞彙形式	
syntactic gap	句法分析中沒有顯性詞語出現的位置	
gapping — linguistics	並列結構中省略重複成分的語法現象	
gap-fill exercise	在空格中補上所缺詞語的填空練習	
information-gap activity	參與者掌握不同資訊、必須溝通來補足資訊的語言活動	
band gap	固體 / 半導體物理中的能帶隙	
spark gap	兩電極之間可發生火花放電的間隙	
air gap — electrical	電氣 / 磁性組件之間的實體氣隙	
air gap — cybersecurity	使敏感系統與其他網絡隔離的安全措施	
gap junction	相鄰細胞直接傳遞離子 / 小分子的間隙連接	
gap phase	細胞周期中的 G1 / G2 gap phases	
gap gene	發育生物學中的特定分節基因類別	
anion gap	臨床酸鹼分析中的陰離子間隙	
osmolal gap	實測與計算滲透濃度差異	
treatment/care gap	需要治療 / 照護與實際獲得服務之間的缺口	
sequence gap	序列比對 / 基因組中的缺失或未解決位置	
gap penalty	生物資訊序列比對中加入 / 延長空位的罰分	
gapless playback	音軌之間沒有可聽停頓的無縫播放	
CSS gap	網頁排版元素之間的間距設定	
gap buffer	文字編輯資料結構中的間隙緩衝區	
expansion gap	為材料熱脹冷縮預留的伸縮間隙	
platform gap	列車與月台之間的空隙	
Mind the gap	小心列車與月台之間的空隙	
fill a gap	提供缺少的東西 / 填補不足	
bridge a gap	連接兩方、彌合差距	
close/narrow a gap	消除 / 縮小差距	
widen a gap	擴大差距	
plug a gap	通常以臨時方法填補不足	
leave a gap	留下一個空缺 / 功能或人手缺口	

| **gapless** | 沒有中斷 / 間隙的；無縫的 |

For your original sentence

> “The fact that proper study space is insufficient does not mean restaurants should be expected to **fill the gap for free**.”

The exact meaning is:

gap = 合適學習空間的實際需求，大於家庭、學校、圖書館、自修室等目前能夠提供的供應，因此形成一個服務 / 資源缺口

So:

> **fill the gap**

= **補上目前不足的學習空間供應**

The writer's argument is specifically:

> a genuine **gap exists**,

> but that does not mean restaurants should automatically become the institutions responsible for **filling it**.

For the core database, I would keep **6 major semantic branches** for **gap**:

1. **physical opening, break, or space between things**
2. **interval in time**
3. **difference/disparity between two levels, groups, or positions**
4. **missing information, service, resource, skill, evidence, or capacity**
5. **unmet opportunity or demand — especially a gap in the market**
6. **specialist measurable/structural interval in technical fields**

Then the database should separately index the major specialist families—**gap year, generation gap, pay gap, funding gap, gap analysis, price gap, lexical/syntactic gap, gap-fill, band gap, air gap, gap junction, anion gap, sequence gap, gapless playback**—because several of these have conventional meanings that cannot be recovered safely from a generic translation such as 「空隙」.